Parent Council Meeting Minutes

School: Howard Public School

Meeting Date: February 25,2026

Location: Howard Public School

Time: 5:02 p.m. – 6:03 p.m.

1. Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 5:02 p.m.

2. Attendance

Administration:

- Alison Bell, Vice Principal
  Brianne Tanner , president
  Sheena Merling, secretary

Teacher Representative:

- Racheal Williams

Parent Council Voting Members:

- Wanda
- Katilyn
- Julie

Community Member:

- Karen New

3. Approval of Previous Minutes

Motion to approve the previous meeting minutes:

- First: Wanda
- Second: Julie
- Motion carried

4. Administration Report – Alison Bell

Staffing and Student Teachers

- Tiffany Martin has returned and is assigned to Room 1.
- Daria Marr is assigned to Room 2.
- Student teachers are currently placed in Rooms 3, 4, 6, 9, and 13.
- A Conestoga College student participating in a supported work experience program is completing placement at the school twice per week under staff supervision.

Online Safety Presentations

- The Sexual Assault Support Centre (SASC) of Waterloo Region is delivering presentations to Grade 5 and 6 students on:
    - Online safety
    - Social media awareness
    - Responsible sharing of information

Upcoming Student Programs

- The Humane Society will be visiting the school to present on dog safety.

5. Facilities and Child Care Centre Update (5:14 p.m.)

- A new child care centre will be built on school property through a partnership between:
    - The School Board
    - Region of Waterloo
    - Healing of the Seven Generations
- Construction is expected to begin Spring 2026, with opening anticipated by December 2026.
- The parking lot will be reconfigured during Summer 2026.
- Existing fencing will be replaced as part of the project.

Playground Replacement

● Playground replacement is under consideration through school board funding. ● Parent Council will be involved in reviewing equipment options if funding is approved.

6. Teacher Report – Racheal Williams (5:14 p.m.)

Athletics and Events

- Basketball season begins February 26, 2026.
- Students will attend the KW Titans game on March 14, 2026, where students will sing O Canada.
- The Orange Jersey Game will take place March 28, 2026, with special guest Phyllis Webstad attending.

Student Programs

- The Game Changers Program with Eastwood Collegiate student volunteers has resumed.
- Laurier University volunteers are supporting classrooms.
- Weekly floor hockey programming is ongoing.

Literacy Update

- Students completed Acadience Reading assessments to benchmark literacy progress.
- The Walk to Read program continues to support literacy development.

7. Fundraising – Popcorn Initiative (5:30 p.m.)

Parent Council discussed launching a pilot popcorn fundraiser.

Purpose

Funds will support:

- Playground equipment
- Student programs
- School activities

Details

- Optional participation
- Paper and digital forms will be available
- Donation options will be available
- Fundraiser will launch following March Break
- Target distribution date: April 17, 2026

Distribution Plan

- Orders will be sorted by classroom
- Delivered directly to classrooms
- Parent and student volunteers will assist

8. Pizza Fundraiser (5:45 p.m.)

Parent Council discussed launching a pizza fundraiser to offset field trip costs.

Details

- Price: approximately $2 per slice
- Participation: Grades 1–6
- Kindergarten classes will be supported separately
- Planned launch: May 2026

Payment

- Monthly payment structure proposed
- Cash initially preferred
- Electronic payment options may be explored

Volunteer Coordination (6:05 p.m.)

- Volunteers will assist with sorting and delivery
- Spreadsheet will be created for volunteer scheduling
- Pizza will be delivered to classrooms

Motion to proceed with pizza fundraiser:

- First: Wanda
- Second: Julie
- Motion carried

9. Book Fair Volunteers (6:15 p.m.)

Book Fair scheduled: May 4–6, 2026

Volunteers needed for:

- Payment table
- Student assistance
- Organization and restocking

Parent Council will send out a volunteer request to families.

10. Community Support and Donations

Parent volunteers offered to assist in securing donations from local businesses such as Home Depot.

11. Staffing Update

Uzma has joined the school as the Multilingual Learner (MLL) teacher.

12. Next Meeting

Date: March 25, 2026

13. Adjournment

Meeting adjourned at 6:03 p.m.